

Benjamin Shaw

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CAREER OBJECTIVE

Senior QA/Testing professional, 11 years in. Track record of taking ambiguous problems through design, delivery and the unglamorous operational work that follows. I mentor deliberately and write things down. Core stack: JavaScript, TypeScript, Selenium.

CAREER HISTORY

Datadog — SDET

09/2016 - 01/2026 | South Lancemouth

- Built the defect triage process and reporting the engineering leads still use.
- Integrated automated checks into the Nginx pipeline, blocking 30 faulty releases.
- Owned release sign-off for 40 services, coordinating across product and support.
- Partnered with developers to shift testing left, embedding QA in refinement sessions.
- Built a performance harness in Cypress simulating 15k concurrent users.

Test Automation Engineer, Lumen Works

11/2013 - 06/2016 | Hallbury (Remote (UK))

- Established test data management practices later adopted by 20 teams.
- Introduced flaky-test quarantine, taking suite reliability from 30% to 94%.
- Reduced escaped defects by 35% through risk-based test prioritisation.
- Mentored 3 manual testers into automation roles.

ACADEMIC BACKGROUND

PhD, Mathematics

Granite Bay University | 2009 - 2013

Thesis: "Convergence bounds for stochastic optimisation methods"

Bachelor, Mathematics

Cedar Hollow University | 2005 - 2008

TECH STACK

JavaScript (8 yrs), TypeScript (1 year), Selenium (7 yrs), Java (8 yrs), Python (6 yrs), Cypress (11 yrs), Playwright (4 yrs), Power BI (2 yrs), Nginx (4 yrs), MLflow (4 yrs), Confluence (2 yrs)

SIDE PROJECTS

Conference talk

Spoke on Cypress in production at a regional meetup, ~80 attendees.

Recipe search engine

Full-text search over a scraped recipe corpus using Java; learned more about ranking than about cooking.

RESEARCH OUTPUT

"Graph partitioning under capacity constraints" - co-authored conference paper, 2015.

"Graph partitioning under capacity constraints" - accepted at a peer-reviewed workshop, 2013.

LANGUAGES

English – Native

INTERESTS

Bouldering, Travel photography, Trail running